

AMERICAN EXPRESS – INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

ABOUT THE COMPANY:

American Express (Amex), founded in 1850 and headquartered in New York City, is one of the **world's leading Multinational Financial Services Corporation**, best known for its credit cards, charge cards, traveller's cheques, and digital payment solutions across more than 110 countries. Amex consistently ranks among the **world's most admired companies**, distinguished by its focus on premium customers, strong rewards programs, and globally trusted brand. With a reputation for customer-centricity and an employee-friendly culture, it is recognized as a **technology-driven organization** and a sought-after workplace for tech professionals.

Eligible Branch: UG: CS, EE, EC, EI, AIDS & IT

Eligibility Criteria: CGPA 7.0 & above, No current arrear

Internship Duration: 8 weeks

Stipend: Rs. 1,25,000

Job Location: Hybrid – Chennai/Bangalore/Gurgaon

Selection Process:

- Online Test
- Technical Interview
- HR Interview

ONLINE ASSESSMENT:

Duration: 90 mins

The test was conducted on **Codility platform** with **3 coding** questions.

1. Graph/Grid pathfinding question similar to [1926. Nearest Exit from Entrance in Maze](#)
2. Prefix Sum question, variant of [2391. Minimum Amount of Time to Collect Garbage](#)
3. Variant of Maximum Subarray Sum

There were example test cases to evaluate your output. **However, the score was based on the number of hidden test cases that passed.**

16 students were shortlisted for the interview.

TECHNICAL INTERVIEW

Duration: 1 hour

The interview was conducted **virtually** on the **Webex platform**. The interview started without much introduction, the interviewer directly opened my resume and began asking technical questions related to the skills I had mentioned in the Skills section. Some of the questions I was asked:

- Difference between Java and JavaScript
- Different libraries in Python and specific libraries used in data analysis
- Working of Web Sockets
- Many syntax questions on Python, JavaScript
- What are decorators in Python and what are they used for?
- Difference between the various data types in Java, Python, JavaScript (these are the 3 languages I had listed)
- What are APIs and Open-Source APIs?

As my interviewer was a Data Engineer, many questions were asked from DBMS.

- What are the bottlenecks faced when designing a database?
- Database tuning/ performance enhancement techniques
- What is data warehousing?
- What is ETL?
- What is database sharding and database partitioning?
- Database backup and recovery techniques

He then moved on to ask about my projects. He was interested in one particular team project and all questions were based on it.

- How we used Google Maps API in it?
- How we implemented live coordination between different interfaces?
- Why this solution is better than any other existing solution?
- How we came up with the idea and how we plan to take forward the project? (It was a project that we planned on giving to the govt.)

He was intrigued by our idea and suggested enhancements for the project that we could look into in the future.

He then moved on to ask about the trending and currently used technologies in AMEX.

- What is GenAI and its influence in fintech?
- What is Cloud Computing?
- Any idea about cloud-native and on-premise app?
- What are Open-Source APIs and have you used any?

- How AMEX could use these technologies to advance?

He explained how AMEX is currently leveraging these technologies and highlighted about the importance to learn and work on such advancing technologies to stay close with the field. The interview ended with me asking him a couple of questions to which he patiently explained in detail.

- What was his role in the company?
- What can a fresher expect from AMEX?

After the interview, around 10 candidates moved forward to the second round.

HR INTERVIEW

Duration: 30 mins

My second round of interview was scheduled immediately after my first round. The interview began with my introduction.

- Since I had mentioned that I was part of various clubs in college, I was asked what they were and what was my role in them.
- I had mentioned about research I was working on and since it was related to the field, I was asked various tricky questions about it.
- She then asked about my projects and why we chose specific tech stacks and databases.
- What are my hobbies?

The entire interview was follow-ups based on what I answered to each question, so be mindful of what you say and avoid mentioning things you don't have a good idea about.

TIPS:

- Start your preparation early if you can. But even if you begin late, consistency matters way more than speed, so stick to a plan and you'll be fine.
- Don't waste weeks looking for resources, pick one and trust the process. If you're unsure, I would recommend you to blindly follow [Striver's A-Z DSA course](#) (safest bet).
- Build a good and clean resume. It's more important than you think, so draft it ahead of your intern season.
- Have one good project, it doesn't need to be flashy but make sure you know its ins and outs before the interview, and can talk about it confidently.

- The day before any interview, glance at senior's placement/intern experience for that company as you can get a good idea of what you can expect.
- Even if you don't know the answers to some questions in interviews, don't panic, communicate it to them and tell them whatever idea you have about that question.
- The most important part is to be confident in your interview. If you don't feel confident, prepare and practice for interviews with as much importance as you prepare DSA.
- Internship season is long, so don't get discouraged by rejections or compare yourself with others. Be patient but consistent with your preparation.

OUTSIDE-OF-PREP TIPS:

- Don't be shy or hesitant to talk to your seniors about **anything** intern/prep related, they have been in the exact same place as you. At most times, you can get direct answers from them to things you might have been confusing about for long.
- Internships are important, but not the end of the world, there are always better chances. This mindset will help you prepare better with less pressure.
- Most importantly, enjoy college. Prep is important but don't sacrifice every college memory.

Internship season can feel scary, before and during, but nobody ever feels fully ready. We've all doubted ourselves, faced rejections, and felt lost. What matters is consistency, patience, and especially bouncing back after those days.

One offer is enough to change everything, so don't stress about others' journey. Prep smart, stay confident, and don't forget to enjoy college along the way, these years won't come back.

All the best for your journey! I'm sure you'll get there soon!
Feel free to reach out anytime!

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